



The Journal for Cultural and Religious Theory (JCRT)

3.3 |

Anaximander and the Architects: the Contributions of Egyptian and Greek Architectural Technologies to the Origins of Greek Philosophy

Michael J Zerbe

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Book Profile: Anaximander and the Architects

a review of Robert Hahn, *Anaximander and the Architects: The Contributions of Egyptian and Greek Architectural Technologies to the Origins of Greek Philosophy*. State University of New York Press, Albany, 2001. 320pp. \$28.95/\$81.50. ISBN: 0791447944

Michael J. Zerbe
York College of Pennsylvania

In *Anaximander and the Architects*, Robert Hahn proposes that ancient Greek scholar Anaximander (and, to a lesser extent, Thales) in specific, and the 6th-century BCE Greek turn toward rationalizing activities in general, were influenced prominently by the Greek architects who planned and built monumental temples to gods such as Hera, Artemis, and Apollo. Hahn asserts that Anaximander, whom Hahn names as the author of the first philosophy text in prose, relied on techniques used by these architects to argue for his vision of the cosmos. Scrupulously researched, soundly supported, and carefully planned, Hahn presents a convincing case.

Michael Zerbe received his doctorate from Purdue University and is an assistant professor of rhetoric at York College of Pennsylvania.

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Updated 07/28/21.
jcrt.org/archives/03.3/zerbe
